

NO CLUE: A bloody handprint on Talwars' terrace wall

UNANSWERED questions

■ Why was the evidence interfered with and why did the site of the crime become almost a tourist destination?

■ What made the Noida police take a U-turn after a week and suspect Talwar? Was it only the confession of his compounder, Krishna? Why did it take CBI 40 days to confirm that there was no evidence against Talwar so far?

■ There is a theory that the Talwars may not have been at home the night of the murders. Cannot CBI establish their whereabouts with the help of their cellphone records?

■ If Krishna and Rajkumar have confessed to their crime,

why has it not led to the recovery of any corroborative evidence?

■ According to CBI, there were four people drinking in the house that night: Hemraj, Rajkumar, Krishna and Mandal. So why were there only three glasses?

■ When did the helpers arrive? Were these impromptu get-togethers at Hemraj's room a usual practice?

■ The motive is not clear. If the three were in league to kill Aarushi, why did they kill Hemraj? If Hemraj objected to their attempt to sexually abuse Aarushi, why did he allow them inside her room?



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Investigation (CBI), which released Aarushi's father from jail for lack of evidence "so far" but stopped short of pronouncing him not guilty. And it is a killing (initially described by the police as an honour killing) that casts uncomfortable doubts on the most sanctified of relationships, between a father and his daughter, even as it mutates into class war, of rich versus poor.

From animated dining table discussions to heated television debates and angry editorials, which have held forth on the dark heart of a society in transition. From a character on Ekta Kapoor's *Kahaani Ghar Ghar Ki* to a B.Ed question in Lucknow University and comparisons with JonBenet Ramsay, a six-year-old child beauty pageant contestant in the US, whose murder in 1996 is still unsolved, Aarushi's murder has run the gamut of a national obsession. A television channel has run video footage morphed to look like Aarushi taking her clothes off. Another

UNITED, IN GRIEF: Nupur (left) with husband Rajesh Talwar

Singh, says Talwar killed his daughter in a fit of rage after finding her in an "objectionable position but not compromising state" with Hemraj. Talwar is sent to judicial custody.

MAY 29 The Uttar

Pradesh Government recommends a CBI probe. A case is registered against Aarushi's father.

JUNE 2 CBI examines Talwars' house, questions friend, dentist Anita Durrani.

JUNE 12 Talwar's compounder Krishna undergoes a narco test, where he confesses his crime. He is arrested.

JUNE 14 Rajkumar, Durrani's domestic help, is subjected to a



lie-detector test.

JUNE 19 Vijay Mandal, the domestic

help of a neighbour of the Talwars is also subjected to a lie-detector test.

JULY 12 Talwar is released from Gaziabad's Dasna jail due to lack of evidence against him.